

"Your Christmas Stock Is OK" Santa Claus

Our customers say the same thing--the ever increasing patronage that this establishment enjoy's tells more in a minute than we could write in a month. When you become a patron of ours you immediately subscribe to the **Brady Service**—that means that you receive the same prompt and courteous attention that has helped us to build from a very modest start, one of Clackamas County's largest and most popular merchandising institutions.

¶ We specialize in the sale of clean, fresh groceries in all staple and fancy lines. Our shelves are inviting storehouses of the BEST the market affords. Also hay, grain, feed and poultry. :- :-

BUYERS AND SELLERS OF
HIDES, WOOL, POTATOES
FARM PRODUCE and
SUPPLIES
HAY, GRAIN and FEED

¶ Albers Molasses Stock Feeds and a hundred other specialties. You will find our stock most complete, our goods new and clean, and our prices very reasonable. You are assured **QUALITY** at this store. :- :- :- :-

Brady Mercantile Co.

1110-1112 MAIN STREET

Wholesale and Retail Grocers :- Commission Merchants
BOTH PHONES

OREGON CITY, OREGON

NATION'S WAR CROP MOST VALUABLE IN HISTORY

America's war crops this year were the most valuable in its history, according to final estimates on acreage, production and value, announced by the department of agriculture on Tuesday.

The record corn crop amounted to 3,159,494,000 bushels with a farm value, December 1, of \$4,053,672,000. Winter and spring wheat production was 650,828,000 bushels, valued at \$1,307,418,000.

The total acreage of winter wheat was estimated at 27,430,000, compared with 34,709,000 in 1916 and a 1911-15 average of 32,950,000. Production per acre was estimated at 15.2 bushels. Total production was estimated at 418,070,000 bushels, compared with 480,553,000 bushels in 1916, and an average for 1911-15 of 542,615,000. The value was estimated at 202.9 cents a bushel or a total of \$848,372,000, compared with \$781,906,000 in 1916 and a 1911-15 average of \$490,098,000.

The total acreage of spring wheat was estimated at 15,511,000, compared with 17,607,000 in 1916 and a 1911-15 average of 18,961,000. Production per acre was estimated at 12.6 bushels as against 8.8 bushels in 1916, and a five year average of

13.9 bushels. Total production was estimated at 232,758,000 bushels, compared with a crop of 155,765,000 bushels in 1916, and an average for 1911-15 of 263,746,000 bushels. The value of the crop was estimated at \$459,046,000, compared with \$238,062,000 in 1916 and a 1911-15 average of \$215,792,000.

The total acreage of all wheat was estimated at 45,941,000 compared with 52,316,000 in 1916 and a 1911-15 average of 51,911,000. Production per acre was estimated at 14.2 bushels as against 12.2 bushels in 1916, and a five-year average of 15.5 bushels. Total production was estimated at 650,828,000 bushels, compared with 636,318,000 bushels in 1916, and an average for 1911-15 of 806,361,000. The value was estimated at 200.9 cents a bushel, or a total of \$1,307,418, compared with \$1,019,968,000 in 1916, and a 1911-15 average of \$705,890,000.

The total acreage of corn is estimated at 119,755,000, compared with 105,296,000 in 1916 and a 1911-15 average of 106,672,000. Production per acre was estimated at 25.4 bushels as against 24.4 in 1916 and a five-year average of 26.1 bushels. Total production was estimated at 3,159,494,000 bushels compared with a crop of 2,566,927,000 bushels in 1916, and an average for 1911-15

of 2,754,164,000. The value of the crop, based on prices paid to farmers December 1, was estimated at 128.3 a bushel or a total of \$4,053,672,000, compared with \$2,280,729,000 in 1916 and a 1911-15 average of \$1,644,511,000.

The total acreage of oats was estimated at 43,572,000, compared with 41,527,000 in 1916 and a 1911-15 average of 38,703,000. Production per acre was estimated at 36.4 bushels as against 30.1 bushels in 1916 and a five-year average of 31.8 bushels. The total production was estimated at 1,587,286,000 bushels, compared with a crop of 1,251,837,000 bushels in 1916, and an average for 1911-15 of 1,230,499,000 bushels. The value of the crop was estimated at 68.4 cents a bushel or a total of \$1,061,427,000, compared with \$655,928,000 in 1916 and a 1911-15 average of \$473,133,000.

The total production of other crops was estimated as follows: Barley 238,975,000 bushels; buckwheat, 17,460,000 bushels; potatoes, 442,536,000 bushels; tobacco, 1,196,451,000 pounds; sugar beets, 6,237,000 tons; rye, 60,145,000 bushels; rice, 36,278,000 bushels; sweet potatoes, 87,141,000 bushels; beans, 15,701,000 bushels.

The total production of cotton for the season of 1917-18 will be estimated, amount to 5,237,379,000 pounds (not including linters), equivalent to 10,490,000 bales of 500 pounds, gross weight (478.3 pounds lint and 21.7 pounds bagging and ties.)

LEAGUE ELECTS

W. T. McNulty of Gladstone is President of Organization

Officers of the Clackamas County School League as follows were elected at the local teachers' institute at Milwaukie grammar school Saturday:

W. T. McNulty, Gladstone, president; J. R. Bowland, Barclay school of Oregon City, vice president; J. V. Fike, principal at Wichita, secretary; Mrs. E. C. Shaw, principal of Milwaukie grammar school, treasurer.

The league, in cooperation with Superintendent J. E. Calavan, has charge of the county essay, short story, debating, oratorical and athletic contests of the high and graded schools of Clackamas county.

At a meeting of the Clackamas County Teachers' association, held at the same time, Mrs. W. A. Barnum, principal of the Mount Pleasant school, was elected president for the coming year. Brenton Vedder, county school supervisor, is the new vice-president and John R. Bowland of the Barclay school was re-elected to be secretary.

Scandinavian Service

There will be Scandinavian services in the Methodist church in Oregon City next Sunday, December 16, at 3 p. m. Rev. John Ovall will preach.

The Courier and Farmer. \$1.00.

How Animals Figure In Christmas Customs

THE Christmas customs in Norway and Sweden are the most interesting of any country. It is time of great rejoicing. To show that there are friendly feelings between every one in the household the shoes are placed in a row in the hall when retreating on Christmas eve, and, like the German custom, candles are left burning in the village windows all night to light the way for "Krisstine," who brings the gifts. The Christmas tree is largely decorated with candles and pretty cakes arranged in bright colored baskets, all usually homemade.

The richer households, send good things to the poor, and everywhere among both rich and poor are the animals and birds remembered, says Our Dumb Animals. The boys and girls save up their pennies during the year for this purpose. Shelves of grain are fastened to the window ledges in town, and in the country the shelves are fastened to long poles and renewed every day for a week, and many are the birds that spy this feast. On the barn floors the peasants bowls of hot porridge are set for poor "Robin Goodfellow" to comfort him because he has no "soul." The cows and the horses share in the general happiness by having a double share of food given them.

It is a big step from the northland to the southland or tropical countries where Christmas is celebrated without the evergreen tree to decorate and hang gifts on. In Brazil the holiday may be spent outdoors in the sunny flower scented air.

They have quaint superstitions in these sunny lands relative to Yuletide. On the coffee plantations the old folk say that on Christmas night the animals have the gift of speech and that if only a child has sufficient courage to go out alone after dark it will hear on the stroke of 12 the cock crow in a loud, clear voice from his highest perch.

"Christo nasceu"—Christ is born. The bull in a deep, sonorous bass inquires from a distant field, "Onde"—where? The sheep then answer in chorus, "Em Belem de Juda"—In Bethlehem of Judea.

In turn all the domestic animals give to the world the glad tidings of the Nativity. Many a child wishes it had the courage necessary to enable him to spend midnight outdoors and hear this wonderful conversation of the brute creation.

CHARGES AGAINST THREE STRIKERS GET AIRING

Justice of the Peace John N. Sievers Monday heard assault and battery charges against Floyd Hogan, Sam Finucane and Thomas Carlson, striking paper mill workers, who were held following an investigation into the fight on the suspension bridge last week between strikers and strikebreakers.

The charges were dismissed as to

Hogan, and the other two were bound over to the grand jury, under \$100 bonds each. Hogan's case was dismissed because the complaining witnesses, Frank Miller and Roy Jeffcott, could not identify him as one of the men who attacked them on the suspension bridge at an early hour last Monday morning. The crowd attending could not get into the justice court rooms, and packed the sidewalks to hear the trial. Its progress was transmitted to them by those in more favored positions.

HE PAID HIS SUB

"Look out for your respective and sundry necks if you dare to stop my paper just because I have let it run a few days over time," announced T. J. Honsenger of route 2, Oregon City, as he slipped a nice bright greenback over the counter in The Courier office and paid his subscription therefrom.

That's the way it is with The Courier's army of subscribers. Most of them come into the office with an awful grouse if we blue pencil their names on our subscription list. And then, just to take a little of the beauty out of life, some bird will fly in and climb our frames because we failed to stop his paper on the very day he told us to a year ago. Anyway, we'd a heap rather make an enemy by continuing the paper a few days too long than by stopping it suddenly.

When successful farmers like our friend, Mr. Honsenger, feel that The Courier is almost indispensable in their households we are glad to add another name to our efforts to maintain The Courier as the biggest and best weekly newspaper in the entire state of Oregon. Show us another weekly rural newspaper in Oregon that publishes as much local news as The Courier and we will gladly make you a Christmas present of a year's subscription. It can't be done! T. J. Honsenger is one of many who know that it can't be done, and he'd be sore as a boil if we stopped his paper. He's one of the friends of the kind we like to have.

On the Xmas Rush

It was just before Christmas. She stood at the hardware counter of a department store, having persistently elbowed her way to the front of the throng. "Will you wait on me, please?" she said in a shrill voice.

"What can I show you?" asked the girl behind the counter. "That's what I'm trying to think of. If you would only advertise

what you have in this department it would be so much easier to remember. I meant to write the name down before I left home, but I didn't. I suppose I ought to have gone to Brown's, they are always so much more helpful there. You used to have some of them on this counter, right over here, in a little tray. It's one of these little doo-dads that are three or four things in one. A kind of thingumajig that part of it folds up—you know what I mean? One of those little jiggers that you find in every kitchen table drawer, or ought to find there, they come in so handy in all sorts of ways—a funny little contraption you can do as much with as you can with a hairpin. It's a combination thingumbob and—don't you know what I mean? I should think you'd know right away what it is. It's the commonest kind of a little rinkum, a combination affair that opens cans and pulls out corks and—

"You mean a combination cork-screw?"

"That's it! I knew I'd remember the name if I put my mind to it. Yes, that's it! How much? Twenty-five cents! Oh, surely not! Why, I can get it at Brown's for fifteen. I think I'll go over there anyway; there are some other things I want, too, and I may as well get them all there."

The Courier and The Oregon Farmer—both for \$1.00.

TWO ASK LETTERS

Would Administer Estates of Late Property Holders

Rosetta Rickabaugh, wife of Charles E. Rickabaugh, and the widow of John Coleman at the time of his death in June, 1911, has petitioned the county court to be appointed administrator of the estate of the latter, valued at \$900, and consisting of a tract in the Willamette Falls tract.

Mansfield Sognichsen died in San Francisco, July 4, 1907, and George A. Wolf, a creditor, has petitioned the county court to be appointed administrator of the estate, valued at \$125, consisting of a lot in Boring, this county.

COP GETS NEW STAR

Mates at Pen Send Morelock Bright Tin Breast Pin

A tin star, measuring 10 1/4 inches from tip to tip and bringing a suggestion that it be riveted to his clothing, was received Monday by L. R. Morelock from his fellow officers at the state penitentiary. Morelock is on special police duty here in connection with the strike. The huge star was sent in care of Parole Officer Joe Keller, and that official called all the state police together to make a ceremony of the presentation. Sheriff Wilson pinned the badge of Morelock. The officer's star of authority was stolen from his room last week while he slumbered.

Christmas Pie Has Long Family History

HAPPY the Christmas reveler who has a digestion to tackle the Christmas pie. The modern fad, dist in diet is trying to rule out the plum pudding and the mince from the Christmas feast.

Shame on him! Better a night of groaning to the few than a bun on a time honored custom for the many. Lay in a stock of soda mint, popsin and salt water. Be sporty and take chances on the plummy goody.

First it was old Santa under a ban—a dreary world it would be without Santa Claus—now it is the toothsome Christmas pie bulging with raisins, flaky of crust and redolent of burning brandy.

Truly the modern progressive who lives by rule is akin to the old Puritan to whom the Christmas pie was an abomination savoring of Popery. Indeed the Roundhead had more excuse for his abstinence; it was a test of orthodoxy. He felt his morals would be injured by eating a pie whose savory contents were typical of offerings of the Magi and whose form was often that of a manger.

The Christmas pie is of ancient and honorable lineage, and its name of "mince pie" came centuries later, being given in derision by the Puritans. Are we such weaklings that what our ancestors have thrived on for centuries will stay us in one eating? Surely the stomach specialist, that product of modernity, must have shipped up.

Our grandparents did not eat one measly little slice of the Christmas pie in fear and trembling. Boldly they swallowed huge hunks, not on Christmas day only, but during the entire season of Christmas, unto Twelfth Night. Was it not writ, "As many different houses as thou shalt eat mince pie during Christmas tide so many happy months shalt thou have during the year?"

"And they began the mixing of that Christmas pie early and with great ceremony. It was a gala occasion when the plum pudding was to be stirred and each member of the household down to the infant in arms must have a turn at the spoon—Philadelphia Press.

In the Days of '61-'65.

"Christmas mornings in the civil war days," said the veteran, "were generally spent in reading letters. After dinner the men indulged in sports, particularly prizefights, and then in the evening they gathered together and sang the wartime songs and told stories of the Christmas before the fighting began. It wasn't all chorale singing, either, for we had some good soloists in the line, and our company actors showed their abilities by reciting or rehearsing the plays they had seen while on furloughs."

The Courier and The Oregon Farmer—both for \$1.00.

HOME COMFORT

Cozy, cheerful warmth— instantly. Portable. Economical. Fuel consumed only when heat is needed—no waste. No smoke or odor.

STANDARD OIL COMPANY (CALIFORNIA)



HEAT WITH PEARL OIL

PERFECTION OIL HEATER

FOR SALE BY

W. E. Estes

Frank Busch

L. Adams

C. W. Friedrich

Hogg Bros.